two-state solution from the get-go. The proposal for such a solution has to come with very clear security guarantees and a stepwise implementation, particularly in light of the trauma of October 7.

It is difficult to know how far Hamas or Islamic Jihad have penetrated the Palestinian population of the West Bank. Repeated Israeli operations in Jenin suggest a strong implantation of terrorist cells in the city and the refugee camp. Today Israeli forces killed fourteen Palestinians in the city and four more in clashes in other parts of the West Bank. A strong Hamas presence in the Occupied Territories would make the two-state solution almost impossible. That is what Hamas wants and also what people like Smotrich and Ben-Gvir wish for.

Israel has agreed to daily four-hour pauses in the fighting to allow inhabitants of the northern part of the enclave to evacuate to the South. The US and Qatar have apparently reached a deal for the liberation of tens of hostages; Hamas wants the liberation of a number (we don't know how many) of its prisoners from Israeli jails. The deal depends on an agreement about the numbers.

Friday, November 10

Secretary of State Antony Blinken said it in New Delhi and the *New York Times* quoted its own sources: the US is getting impatient. This is going on for too long, too many civilians are being killed, the risk of a wider conflict is growing—in short, American all-out support is reaching its limit. What will Israel do? It cannot stand alone against the whole world, but it also cannot cease its military operations and let Hamas claim victory. Accept a ceasefire? Change the nature of its operations and reduce the scope and scale of its fighting? Is that possible? In the meantime, Israeli military correspondents on the front lines in Gaza report that the discipline in Hamas's ranks is weakening and that some of their people are running